

ENGLAND'S TEST SCHEDULE



May 2025

Zimbabwe (Home, 1 Test)

June-August 2025

India (Home, 5 Tests)

November 2025-January 2026

Australia (Away, 5 Tests)

June 2026

New Zealand (Home, 3 Tests)

August-September 2026

Pakistan (Home, 3 Tests)

December 2026-February 2027

South Africa (Away, 3 Tests)

February 2027

Bangladesh (Away, 2 Tests)



AFP

ENGLAND'S NEW BATTING APPROACH UNDER MCCULLUM AND STOKES IS SO ALL-PERVADING THAT IT HAS MANAGED TO PERMEATE ROOT'S CLOAK OF TEXTBOOK BATTING

Kohli is now a shadow of the dominant batter he was around 2016. Smith's idiosyncratic style no longer delivers the Bradmanesque run tallies of the past. Williamson has been plagued by relentless injuries, preventing him from enjoying a sustained period of run-scoring.

All the while, Root has moved steadily forward, aided significantly by the 'Bazball' phenomenon. The arrival of Brendon McCullum as England's Test coach, combined with the proactive captaincy of Ben Stokes, has seen England bat at an unprecedented tempo in Test cricket.

This sense of batting urgency was so all-pervading that it even managed to permeate Root's cloak of textbook batting. This is best evidenced by the right-handed batter's recent tendency to take on

pacers using the outrageous reverse scoop over slips.

Since McCullum's appointment, Root has scored at a strike rate of 68.61, compared to a measly 54.65

in the preceding decade.

England's renewed fascination with Test cricket has offered Root the perfect runway to launch himself towards the summit of cricket's statistical Mt. Everest. With innovative shots in his repertoire and buoyant form under his wings, it will hardly surprise anyone if he topples Sachin and co. from their perch at the pinnacle of the game.

